

Reservoir

A **reservoir** (from French *réservoir* – a "tank") is, most commonly, an enlarged natural or artificial lake, pond or impoundment created using a dam or lock to store water.

Reservoirs can be created in a number of ways, including controlling a watercourse that drains an existing body of water, interrupting a watercourse to form an embayment within it, through excavation, or building any number of retaining walls or levees.

Defined as a storage space for fluids, reservoirs may hold water or gasses, including hydrocarbons. *Tank reservoirs* store these in ground-level, elevated, or buried tanks. Tank reservoirs for water are also called cisterns. Most underground reservoirs are used to store liquids, principally either water or petroleum, below ground.



Kardzali Reservoir in Bulgaria is a reservoir in the Rhodope Mountains.

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